



# Africa

## Cameroonian Highlands Forest

**Location** Eastern Nigeria and western Cameroon, West Africa

This moist broadleaf forest grows at elevations above 2,950 ft (900 m) on the fertile soils of a range of extinct volcanoes in an area roughly 390 miles (625 km) by 110 miles (180 km). Because of its altitude, the climate is cooler than most of tropical Africa, and parts of the forest experience heavy rainfall. Afromontane trees, including brittle-wood, yellow-wood, African cherry, and Cape beech, are plentiful. The forest is home to numerous endemic plants, reptiles, birds, and mammals, and there are also several species of endangered primates, including western gorillas and chimpanzees.

## East African Coastal Forests

**Location** Coastal regions from southern Mozambique to southern Somalia, East Africa

The tropical and subtropical moist forest extends over 43,200 square miles (112,000 square km), stretching in a relatively narrow strip just inland from the Indian Ocean. Its mosaic of closed-canopy woodland, more open savanna, grassland, and wetland varies from south to north. Much has been cleared for farmland, but it remains home to more than 600 species of resident and seasonal migrant birds.

### Other forests in Africa

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### Other forests in Europe

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# Asia

## Russian Far East Temperate Forest

**Location** The Sikhote-Alin mountains of Primorsky Krai and Khararovsky Krai, Russian Far East

After escaping glaciation during the last ice age, this region of mixed broadleaf and conifer forest covering the Sikhote-Alin mountain range became a refuge for many animal species. Today, it is an area of extraordinary biodiversity, with a small population of Amur tigers and Amur leopards. This is the only forest on Earth where tigers, leopards, and brown bears coexist. Plant diversity is varied, with at least 2,500 species known. Broadleaf trees are common at lower elevations but conifers become dominant as the altitude increases. Winters are bitterly cold,

summers are mild, and rainfall can be heavy during summer and fall.

## The Forest of the Cedars of God

**Location** Mount Makmel, northern Lebanon

Protected since 1876, this is the most famous surviving remnant of the cedar forest that once covered much of the Lebanese mountains. For thousands of years, a succession of civilizations used cedar wood for shipbuilding and the construction of important buildings, so the forest is now only a fraction of its former size. The 375 trees of the forest grow at an elevation of more than 6,200 ft (1,900 m) on Mount Makmel, whose slopes are blanketed by snow in winter. Four of the cedars are more than 115 ft (35 m) tall.

▼ WOODED SLOPES IN THE FOREST OF THE CEDARS OF GOD

